quality of chart information for the areas in which they intend to operate;

.3 be aware of potential chart datum discrepancies with GNSS positioning ; and

.4 aim to plan their route through charted areas and well clear of known shoal depths, following established routes whenever possible.

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SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf
.3 be aware of potential chart datum discrepancies with GNSS positioning ; and

.4 aim to plan their route through charted areas and well clear of known shoal depths, following established routes whenever possible.

10.3 Any deviations from the planned route should be undertaken with particular caution. For example, and when operating on the continental shelf:

.1 the echo-sounder should be working and monitored to detect any sign of unexpected depth variation, especially when the chart is not based on a full search of the sea floor; and

.2 independent cross-checking of positioning information (e.g. visual and radar fixing and GNSS) should be undertaken at every opportunity. Mariners should ensure to report to the relevant charting authority (Hydrographic Office) any information that might contribute to improving the nautical charts and publications.

10.4 Ships should be fitted with:

.1 a suitable means to de-ice sufficient conning position windows to provide unimpaired forward and astern vision from conning positions; and



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unimpaired forward and astern vision from conning positions; and

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.2 an efficient means of clearing melted ice, freezing rain, snow, mist and spray from outside and accumulated condensation from inside. A mechanical means to clear moisture from the outside face of a window should have operating mechanisms protected from freezing or the accumulation of ice that would impair effective operation.

11 Additional guidance to chapter 10 (Communication)

11.1 Limitations of communication systems in high latitude

11.1.1 Current maritime digital communication systems were not designed to cover polar waters.

11.1.2 VHF is still largely used for communication at sea, but only over short distances (line of sight) and normally only for voice communication. HF and MF are also used for emergency situations. Digital VHF, mobile phone systems and other types of wireless technology offer enough digital capacity for many maritime applications, but only to ships within sight of shore-based stations, and are, therefore, not generally available in polar

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technology offer enough digital capacity for many maritime applications, but only to ships within sight of shore-based stations, and are, therefore, not generally available in polar waters. AIS could also be used for low data-rate communication, but there are very few base stations, and the satellite-based AIS system is designed for data reception only.

11.1.3 The theoretical limit of coverage for GEO systems is 81.3° North or South, but instability and signal dropouts can occur at latitudes as low as 70° North or South under certain conditions. Many factors influence the quality of service offered by GEO systems, and they have different effects depending on the system design.

11.1.4 Non-GMDSS systems may be available and may be effective for communication in polar waters.

11.2 Advice for the operation of multiple alerting and communication devices in the event of an incident

11.2.1 A procedure should be developed to ensure that when survival craft are in close proximity, not more than two alerting or locating devices are activated (as required by regulation 10.3.2) at the same time. This is to:

.1 preserve battery life;

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proximity, not more than two alerting or locating devices are activated (as required by regulation 10.3.2) at the same time. This is to:

.1 preserve battery life;

.2 enable extended periods of time for the transmission of alerting or locating signals; and

.3 avoid potential interference.

11.2.2 For satellite distress beacons, although multiple beacon transmissions can be detected successfully by the satellite system, it is not recommended to activate multiple beacons, unless the survival craft operating the beacons are widely dispersed, as this can

cause interference on direction-finding equipment.

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11.3 Advice on location and communication equipment to be carried by rescue boats and survival craft

In determining the equipment to be carried for transmitting signals for location, the capabilities of the search and rescue resources likely to respond should be borne in mind. Responding ships and aircraft may not be able to home to 406/121.5 MHz, in which case other locating devices (e.g. AIS-SART) should be considered.

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capabilities of the search and rescue resources likely to respond should be borne in mind. Responding ships and aircraft may not be able to home to 406/121.5 MHz, in which case other locating devices (e.g. AIS-SART) should be considered.

12 Additional guidance to chapter 11 (Voyage planning)

In developing and executing a voyage plan ships should consider the following:

.1 in the event that marine mammals are encountered, any existing best practices should be considered to minimize unnecessary disturbance; and

.2 planning to minimize the impact of the ship's voyage where ships are trafficking near areas of cultural heritage and cultural significance.

(see also additional guidance to chapter 9)

13 Additional guidance to chapter 12 (Manning and training)

No additional guidance.

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PART II-A
POLLUTION PREVENTION MEASURES

CHAPTER 1 PREVENTION OF POLLUTION BY OIL

1.1 Operational requirements

1.1.1 In Arctic waters any discharge into the sea of oil or oily mixtures from any ship shall be prohibited.

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PART II-A
POLLUTION PREVENTION MEASURES

# CHAPTER 1 PREVENTION OF POLLUTION BY OIL

## 1.1 Operational requirements

1.1.1 In Arctic waters any discharge into the sea of oil or oily mixtures from any ship shall be prohibited.

1.1.2 The provisions of paragraph 1.1.1 shall not apply to the discharge of clean or segregated ballast.

1.1.3 Subject to the approval of the Administration, a category A ship constructed before 1 January 2017 that cannot comply with paragraph 1.1.1 for oil or oily mixtures from machinery spaces and is operating continuously in Arctic waters for more than 30 days shall comply with paragraph 1.1.1 not later than the first intermediate or renewal survey, whichever comes first, one year after 1 January 2017. Until that date such ships shall comply with the discharge requirements of regulation 15.3 of MARPOL Annex I.

1.1.4 Operation in polar waters shall be taken into account, as appropriate, in the